

Guitar Harmony

Music theory and chord progressions for guitarists

Circle of fifths · chord functions · 12 major + 12 minor keys · chord diagrams · barre & capo

- 1 Tones, semitones & chord building** the chromatic scale · major & minor scales · stacked thirds (p. 2)
- 2 Chord functions & the circle** I/IV/V/vi · cadences · why the circle works (p. 3)
- 3 Fretboard practice** reading diagrams · barre & capo · transposing · minor tricks (p. 4)
- 4 Major keys** C · G · D · A · E · B · F[♯] · D^b · A^b · E^b · B^b · F (p. 5–16)
- 5 Minor keys** a · e · b · f[♯] · c[♯] · g[♯] · d[♯] · b^b · f · c · g · d (p. 17–28)

Repo and edits: github.com/Vilda007/kytara-harmonicke-postupy — generators `kytara-gen.py` (major), `kytara-gen-moll.py` (minor), `kytara-gen-book.py` (book), `kytara-gen-book-en.py` (EN book).

MIT licence (LICENSE). Diagrams optimized for A4 print; colors = chord functions (green tonic, ochre subdominant, red dominant, blue minor).

Tones, semitones & chord building

The chromatic scale (12 tones) and the major scale

major scale = 7 steps, W = whole step, H = half step

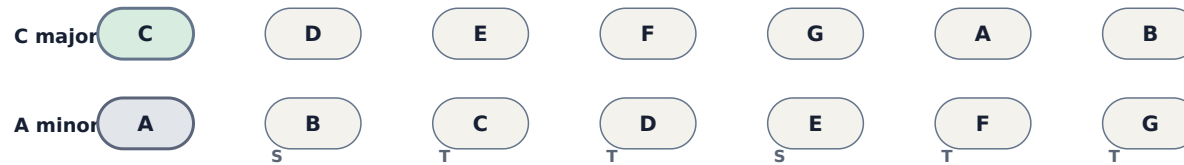


The major scale = whole-whole-half-whole-whole-whole-half (from C: the white piano keys). An octave = 12 semitones = the same tone up.

A key = the same tones transposed anywhere (the pattern holds): G major = one sharp (F#) only, D major = F# + C#, etc.

On the guitar a semitone = one fret; a whole step = two frets. The #/♭ signs shift a tone by a half step.

Major vs. minor — same tones, different home

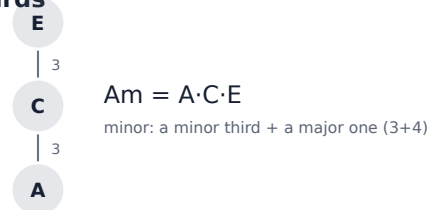
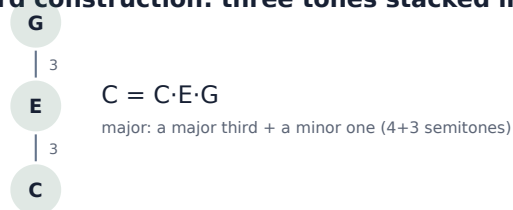


A minor = the RELATIVE MINOR of C major: the same seven tones, but tonic = A. The minor pattern: whole-half-whole-whole-half-whole-whole.

In sound: major = bright/open, minor = darker; the difference is not the tones but where the song calls home.

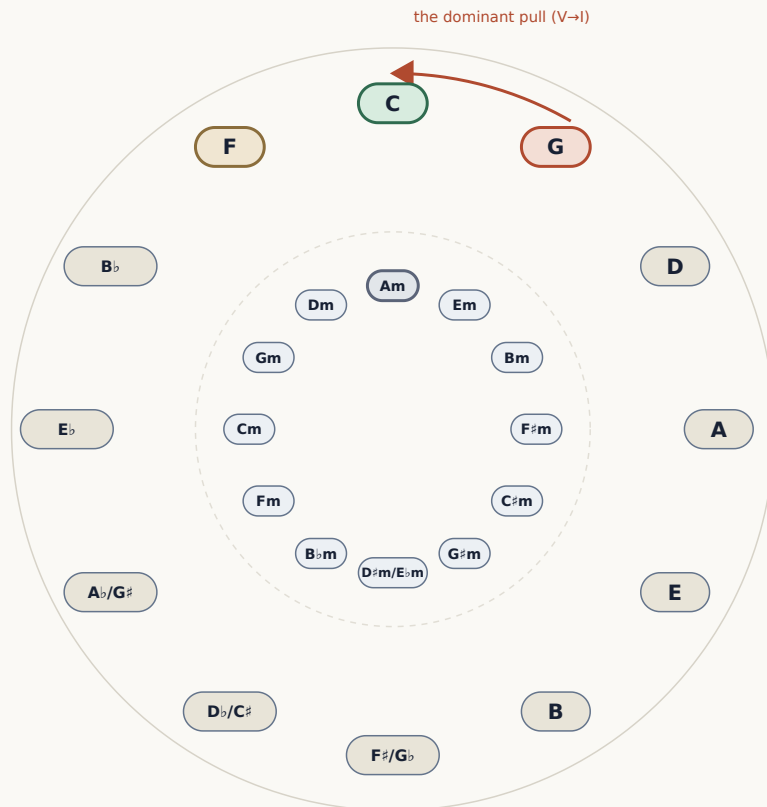
A note on names: Czech tradition says H where we say B natural (B♭ = their B). The repo diagrams keep international names (B, B♭).

Chord construction: three tones stacked in thirds



A seventh = add one more third (C7 = C·E·G·B♭) — very common in blues. A chord is named after its lowest tone (its root).

Chord functions & the circle



The C major example: V (G) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (F) on the left, vi (Am) inside the ring — the whole circle works identically for every key.

Why the circle works: clockwise = a fifth (7), counterclockwise = a fourth (5).

Each clockwise step adds one #, counterclockwise drops one b.

Sharps: F# C# G# D# A# E# B# · flats: Bb Eb Ab Db Gb Cb Fb.

Circle of fifths = a map of relations: V = home, IV = look around, vi = sadness, III = escape.

Functions = chord roles inside a key

I	tonic	home, rest — the song rests on it
IV	subdominant	moving away — opens up, a fresh breath
V	dominant	tension — pulls back to the tonic (V→I)
vi	relative minor	a second home — colours the song minor
ii·iii·vii°	a side role	bridges, colors, turnarounds

Cadences — typical pulls (in C major)

V → I	G → C	the firm resolution
IV → I	F → C	the plagal "Amen"
ii - V - I	Dm - G → C	a jazz turnaround

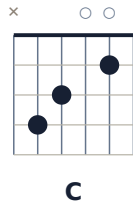
Minor roles (in A minor)

i tonic	the home (Am)
iv + VI	the subdominant (Dm, F)
v minor dominant	soft: Em — it glides, no push
V7, the sharp dominant	E7 = E-G#-B-D: G# = the raised 7th
III, the major sibling	the "escape door" (C)

HARMONIC MINOR = a raised 7th (the 7th degree; A minor: G→G#) — the dominant rises from v (Em) to V7 (E7) and the v→i pull then sounds like a major V→I. Skip ii° (Bdim) on guitar — iv (Dm) fills in fine.

Fretboard practice — diagrams, barre, capo and transposing progressions

How to read the chord diagrams



the thick top line = fret 0 (the nut)

x = don't pluck, o = open string

a dot = a fingertip; the columns = strings

E A D G B e (left = lowest → highest)

on barres: the left number = the starting fret

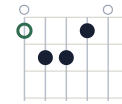
Notes on the guitar: every fret = a semitone. Open strings: E(6th) A(5th) D(4th) G(3rd) B(2nd) e(1st).

A chord = 3-5 strings at once; a muted string (x) just stays dead — the rest ringing is fine.

The diagrams keep international names (B, B^b); Czech players often say H for B natural.

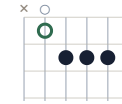
A barre = one finger across all strings → one shape anywhere on the neck.

Barre shapes and the capo



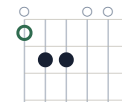
E major

F=1·G=3·A=5·B=7·C=8·D=10
tonic on string 6



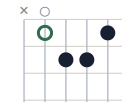
A major

B=2·C=3·D=5·E=7·F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor

F#m=2·Gm=3·Am=5·Bm=7
tonic on string 6



Am minor

Bm=2·Cm=3·Dm=5·Em=7
tonic on string 5

CAPO = the clamp: it shortens all strings at fret N → easy-key shapes play N semitones up.

Easy major shapes: C · G · D · A · E — easy minor shapes: Am · Em. Everything else = the same shapes + a capo.

Choosing: the nearest easy key = fewer barre frets (e.g. B^b minor: capo 1 + A-minor shapes).

Transposing a progression into any key — step by step

- 1 Pick a progression** e.g. the pop four-chord I-V-vi-IV
- 2 Find the tonic on the circle** your target key (anywhere on the circle)
- 3 Read the neighbourhood** V = clockwise, IV = counterclockwise, vi = the inner chip below the tonic
- 4 Rewrite the chords** the same romans, new names
- 5 Pick shapes or a capo** easy-key open shapes + a capo, or a barre

Example: the four-chord I-V-vi-IV in E major (C → E = shifted 4 semitones): E - B - C[#]m - A; the easy route: capo 4 + C-major shapes.

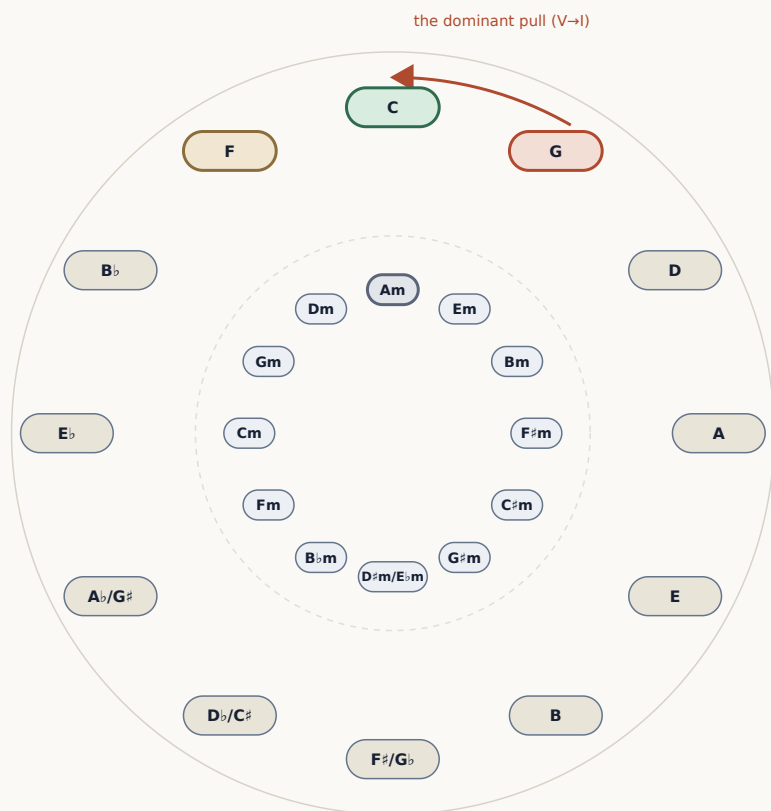
Minor-key tricks: ii° → replace with iv · v → V7 (harmonic minor, raised 7th) · the Andalusian cadence i-VII-VI-V = a minor descent from home.

Blues (12 bars): major: I×4-IV×2-I×2-V-IV-I-V · minor: i×4-iv×2-i×2-V7-iv-i-V7 (V7 = the raised 7th).

Play the progressions slowly at 60 BPM and change chords on the beat. Colours in the diagrams = chord functions → your eyes find them fast.

Chord progressions in C major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in C major

I · C tonic	ii · Dm subdom.	iii · Em linking	IV · F subdom.	V · G dominant	vi · Am rel. minor	vii° · Bdim side
x ○ ○	x x ○	○ ○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	x ○ ○	x ○ ○
C I · tonic	Dm ii · subdom.	Em iii · linking	F IV · subdom.	G V · dominant	Am vi · rel. minor	Bdim vii° · skip it pull substitute: B7 x21202

Notation: ○ = open string, x = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in C major)

I - IV - V	C - F - G	the staple of rock and folk
I - V - vi - IV	C - G - Am - F	the pop "four-chord"
vi - IV - I - V	Am - F - C - G	the same four chords, but home in the minor
I - vi - IV - V	C - Am - F - G	do-wop, the 1950s
ii - V - I	Dm - G - C	a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

C7	C7	C7	C7	F7	F7	C7	C7	G7	F7	C7	G7
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Transposing on the guitar: one barre shape, any key

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

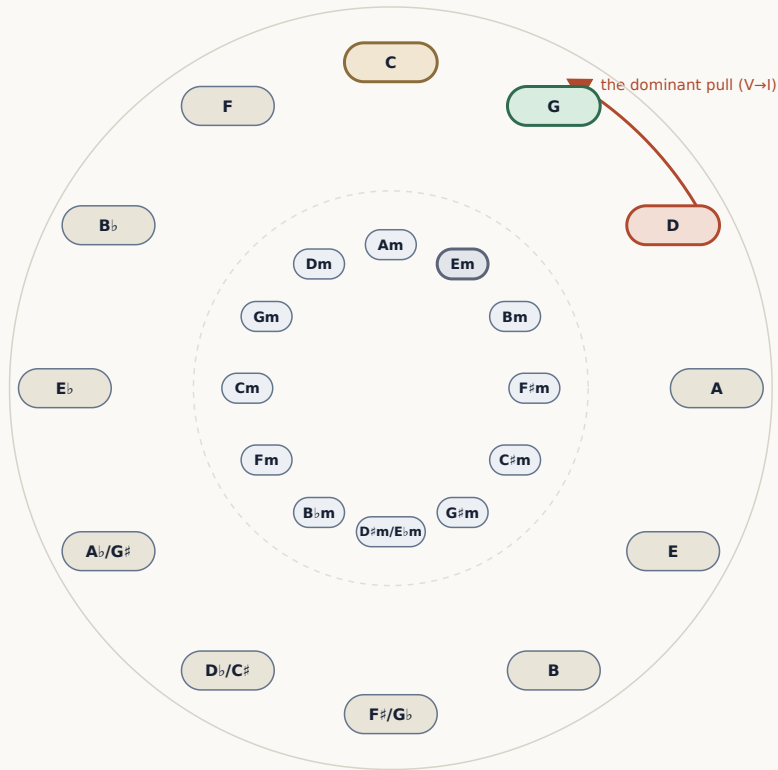
Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

How to read it: a barre = one finger across all strings, at the chosen fret — the shape stays, only the position changes. The green ring marks where the tonic sits (the chord's name). Progressions work in ANY key — you shift them along the circle of fifths: e.g. C-G-Am-F → G major: G-D-Em-C (a 7-fret shift).

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in G major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in G major

I · G tonic	ii · Am subdom.	iii · Bm linking	IV · C subdom.	V · D dominant	vi · Em rel. minor	vii° · F#dim side
○ ○ ○	× ○ ○	○ ×	× ○ ○	× × ○	○ ○ ○	
G I · tonic	Am ii · subdom.	Bm iii · linking	C IV · subdom.	D V · dominant	Em vi · rel. minor	

F#dim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
F#7
242322

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in G major)

I - IV - V	G - C - D	the staple of rock and folk
I - V - vi - IV	G - D - Em - C	the pop "four-chord"
vi - IV - I - V	Em - C - G - D	the same four chords, but home in the minor
I - vi - IV - V	G - Em - C - D	do-wop, the 1950s
ii - V - I	Am - D - G	a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

G7	G7	G7	G7	C7	C7	G7	G7	D7	C7	G7	D7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of G:

capo 2 + F major shapes

G, Am, Bm, C, D, Em — all easy.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

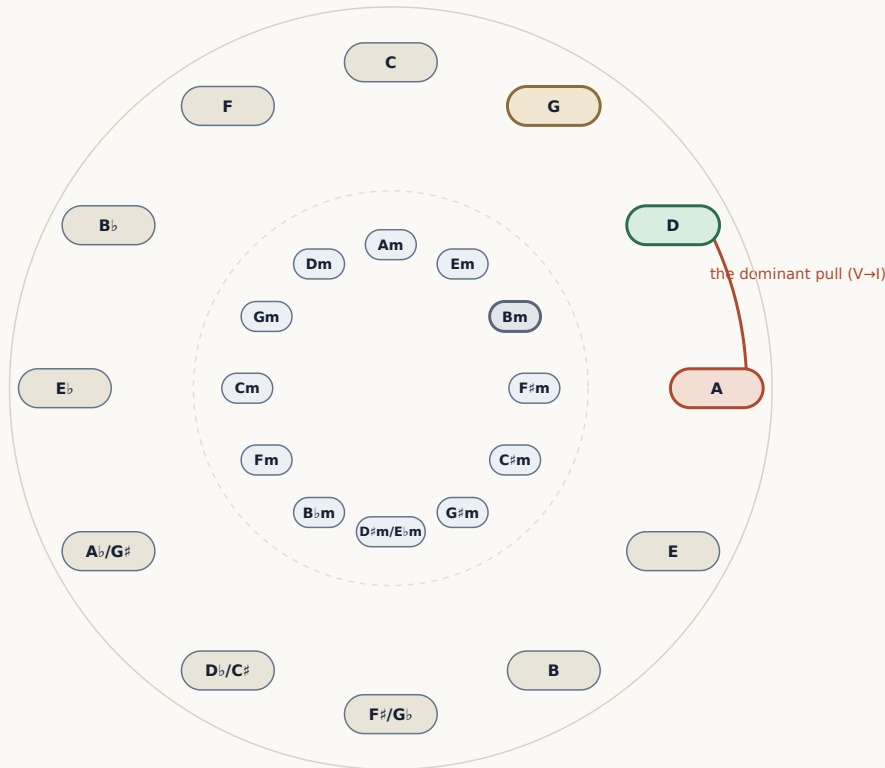
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in D major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Diatonic chords in D major

I · D tonic	ii · Em subdom.	iii · F#m linking	IV · G subdom.	V · A dominant	vi · Bm rel. minor	vii° · C#dim side
x x o	o o o o	2 x x x x x	o o o	x o o x	2 x x x x x	
D I · tonic	Em ii · subdom.	F#m iii · linking	G IV · subdom.	A V · dominant	Bm vi · rel. minor	

C#dim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
C#7
x46464

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in D major)

I - IV - V	D - G - A	the staple of rock and folk
I - V - vi - IV	D - A - Bm - G	the pop "four-chord"
vi - IV - I - V	Bm - G - D - A	the same four chords, but home in the minor
I - vi - IV - V	D - Bm - G - A	do-wop, the 1950s
ii - V - I	Em - A - D	a jazz turnaround
Blues, 12 bars:	D7 D7 D7 D7 G7 G7 D7 D7 A7 G7 D7 A7	

Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10 tonic on string 6	A major shape B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8 tonic on string 5	Em minor shape F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10 tonic on string 6	Am minor shape Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8 tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of D:

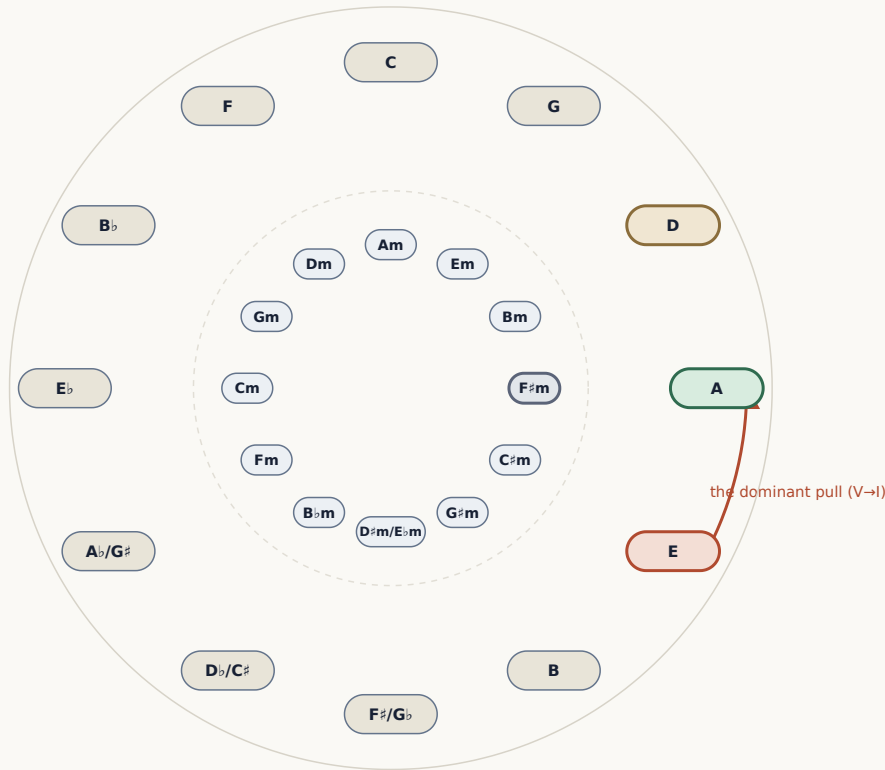
capo 2 + C major shapes
D, Em, F#m, G, A, Bm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in A major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in A major

I · A tonic	ii · Bm subdom.	iii · C#m linking	IV · D subdom.	V · E dominant	vi · F#m rel. minor	vii° · G#dim side
x ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	x ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	x ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	x x ○ ○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
A I · tonic	Bm ii · subdom.	C#m iii · linking	D IV · subdom.	E V · dominant	F#m vi · rel. minor	

G#dim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
G#7
464544

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in A major)

I - IV - V

A - D - E

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

A - E - F#m - D

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

F#m - D - A - E

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

A - F#m - D - E

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

Bm - E - A

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

A7	A7	A7	A7	D7	D7	A7	A7	E7	D7	A7	E7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of A:

capo 2 + G major shapes

A, Bm, C#m, D, E, F#m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

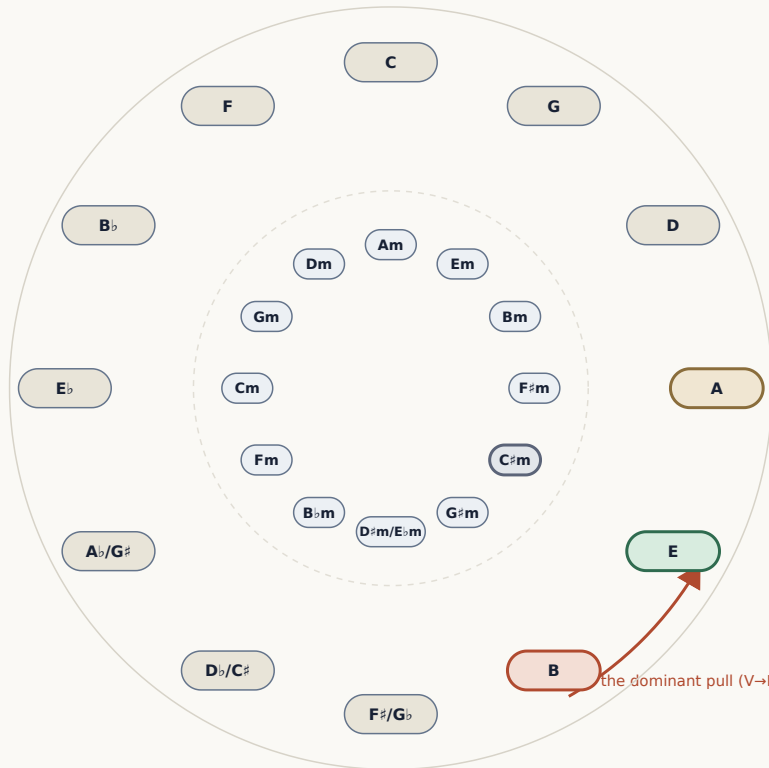
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in E major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in E major

I · E tonic	ii · F#m subdom.	iii · G#m linking	IV · A subdom.	V · B dominant	vi · C#m rel. minor	vii° · D#dim side
E I · tonic	F#m ii · subdom.	G#m iii · linking	A IV · subdom.	B V · dominant	C#m vi · rel. minor	D#dim vii° · skip it pull substitute: D#7 x68686

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in E major)

I - IV - V	E - A - B	the staple of rock and folk
I - V - vi - IV	E - B - C#m - A	the pop "four-chord"
vi - IV - I - V	C#m - A - E - B	the same four chords, but home in the minor
I - vi - IV - V	E - C#m - A - B	do-wop, the 1950s
ii - V - I	F#m - B - E	a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

E7	E7	E7	E7	A7	A7	E7	E7	B7	A7	E7	B7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10 tonic on string 6	A major shape B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8 tonic on string 5	Em minor shape F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10 tonic on string 6	Am minor shape Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8 tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of E:

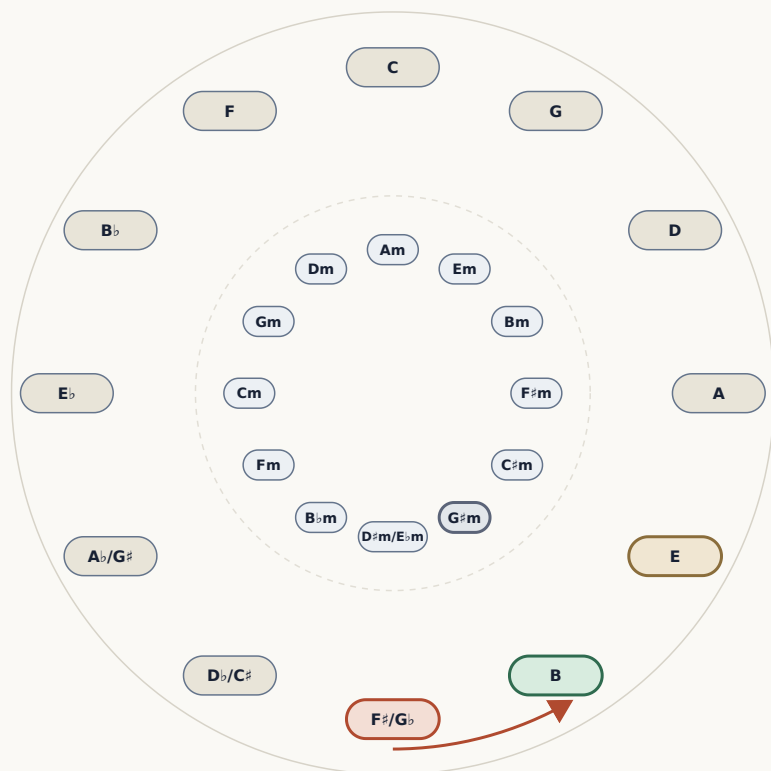
capo 2 + D major shapes
E, F#m, G#m, A, B, C#m — fewer barres.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in B major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in B major

I · B tonic	ii · C#m subdom.	iii · D#m linking	IV · E subdom.	V · F# dominant	vi · G#m rel. minor	vii° · A#dim side
x	x	x	o o o			
2	4	6		2	4	
B I · tonic	C#m ii · subdom.	D#m iii · linking	E IV · subdom.	F# V · dominant	G#m vi · rel. minor	

A#dim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
A#7
x13131

Notation: o = open string, x = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in B major)

I - IV - V

B - E - F#

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

B - F# - G#m - E

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

G#m - E - B - F#

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

B - G#m - E - F#

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

C#m - F# - B

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

B7	B7	B7	B7	E7	E7	B7	B7	F#7	E7	B7	F#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of B:

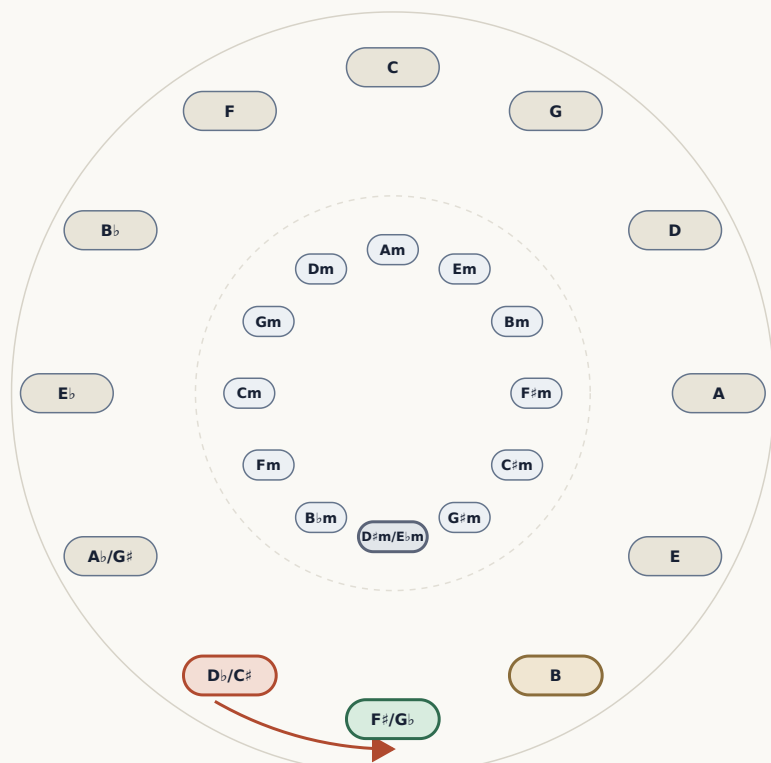
capo 2 + A major shapes
B, C#m, D#m, E, F#, G#m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in F# major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



the dominant pull (V-I)
Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in F# major

I · F# tonic	ii · G#m subdom.	iii · A#m linking	IV · B subdom.	V · C# dominant	vi · D#m rel. minor	vii° · E#dim side
2	4	x	x	x	x	
F# I · tonic	G#m ii · subdom.	A#m iii · linking	B IV · subdom.	C# V · dominant	D#m vi · rel. minor	E#dim vii° · skip it pull substitute: E#7 = F7 131211

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in F# major)

I - IV - V	F# - B - C#	the staple of rock and folk
I - V - vi - IV	F# - C# - D#m - B	the pop "four-chord"
vi - IV - I - V	D#m - B - F# - C#	the same four chords, but home in the minor
I - vi - IV - V	F# - D#m - B - C#	do-wop, the 1950s
ii - V - I	G#m - C# - F#	a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

F#7	F#7	F#7	F#7	B7	B7	F#7	F#7	C#7	B7	F#7	C#7
-----	-----	-----	-----	----	----	-----	-----	-----	----	-----	-----

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of F#:

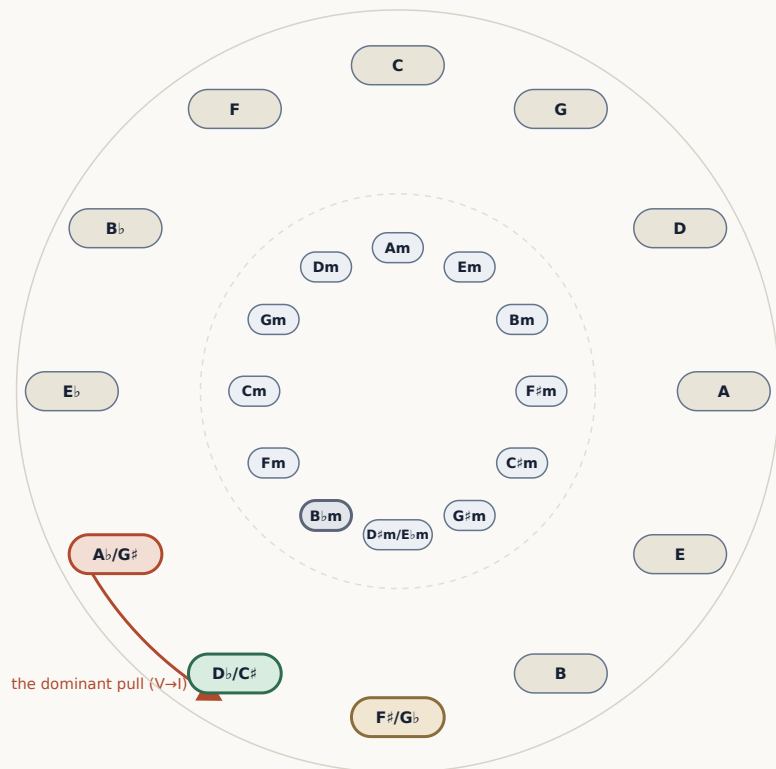
capo 2 + E major shapes
F#, G#m, A#m, B, C#, D#m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in D $\flat$ major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in D $\flat$ major

I · D $\flat$ tonic	ii · E $\flat$ m subdom.	iii · Fm linking	IV · G $\flat$ subdom.	V · A $\flat$ dominant	vi · B $\flat$ m rel. minor	vii $^\circ$ · Cdim side
9	6		2	4	x	
D $\flat$ I · tonic	E $\flat$ m ii · subdom.	Fm iii · linking	G $\flat$ IV · subdom.	A $\flat$ V · dominant	B $\flat$ m vi · rel. minor	Cdim vii $^\circ$ · skip it pull substitute: C7 x32310

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in D $\flat$ major)

I - IV - V	D$\flat$ - G$\flat$ - A$\flat$	the staple of rock and folk
I - V - vi - IV	D$\flat$ - A$\flat$ - B$\flat$m - G$\flat$	the pop "four-chord"
vi - IV - I - V	B$\flat$m - G$\flat$ - D$\flat$ - A$\flat$	the same four chords, but home in the minor
I - vi - IV - V	D$\flat$ - B$\flat$m - G$\flat$ - A$\flat$	do-wop, the 1950s
ii - V - I	E$\flat$m - A$\flat$ - D$\flat$	a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

D $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	G $\flat$ 7	G $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	G $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7
-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of D $\flat$:

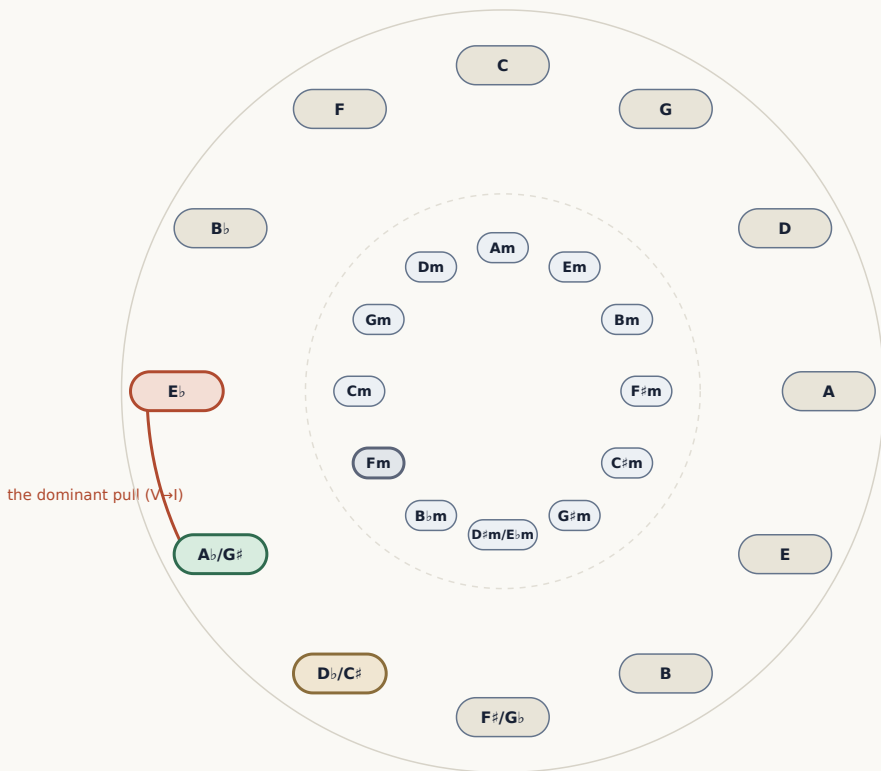
capo 1 + C major shapes
D $\flat$, E $\flat$ m, Fm, G $\flat$, A $\flat$, B $\flat$ m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in A $\flat$ major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in A $\flat$ major

I · A $\flat$ tonic	ii · B $\flat$ m subdom.	iii · Cm linking	IV · D $\flat$ subdom.	V · E $\flat$ dominant	vi · Fm rel. minor	vii $^{\circ}$ · Gdim side
4	x	x	9	x	6	
A $\flat$ I · tonic	B $\flat$ m ii · subdom.	Cm iii · linking	D $\flat$ IV · subdom.	E $\flat$ V · dominant	Fm vi · rel. minor	

Gdim
vii $^{\circ}$ · skip it
pull substitute:
G7
320001

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in A $\flat$ major)

I - IV - V

A $\flat$ - D $\flat$ - E $\flat$

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

A $\flat$ - E $\flat$ - Fm - D $\flat$

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Fm - D $\flat$ - A $\flat$ - E $\flat$

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

A $\flat$ - Fm - D $\flat$ - E $\flat$

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

B $\flat$ m - E $\flat$ - A $\flat$

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

A $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ 7	D $\flat$ 7	A $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ 7
-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------	-------------

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of A $\flat$:

capo 1 + G major shapes

A $\flat$, B $\flat$ m, Cm, D $\flat$, E $\flat$, Fm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

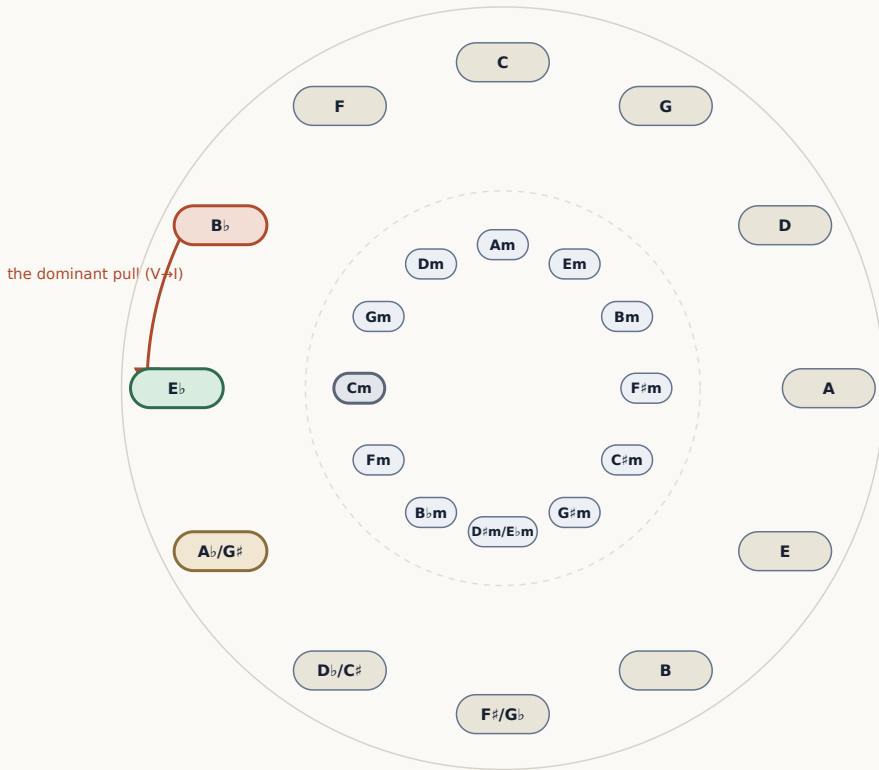
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in E_b major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in E_b major

I · E _b tonic	ii · Fm subdom.	iii · Gm linking	IV · A _b subdom.	V · B _b dominant	vi · Cm rel. minor	vii° · Ddim side
x	x	3	x	x	x	
6			4		3	
E _b I · tonic	Fm ii · subdom.	Gm iii · linking	A _b IV · subdom.	B _b V · dominant	Cm vi · rel. minor	

Ddim
vii° · skip it
pull substitute:
D7
xx0212

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in E_b major)

I - IV - V

E_b - A_b - B_b

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

E_b - B_b - Cm - A_b

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Cm - A_b - E_b - B_b

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

E_b - Cm - A_b - B_b

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

Fm - B_b - E_b

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

E _b 7	E _b 7	E _b 7	E _b 7	A _b 7	A _b 7	E _b 7	E _b 7	B _b 7	A _b 7	E _b 7	B _b 7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6

A major shape
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5

Em minor shape
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6

Am minor shape
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of E_b:

capo 3 + C major shapes

E_b, Fm, Gm, A_b, B_b, Cm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

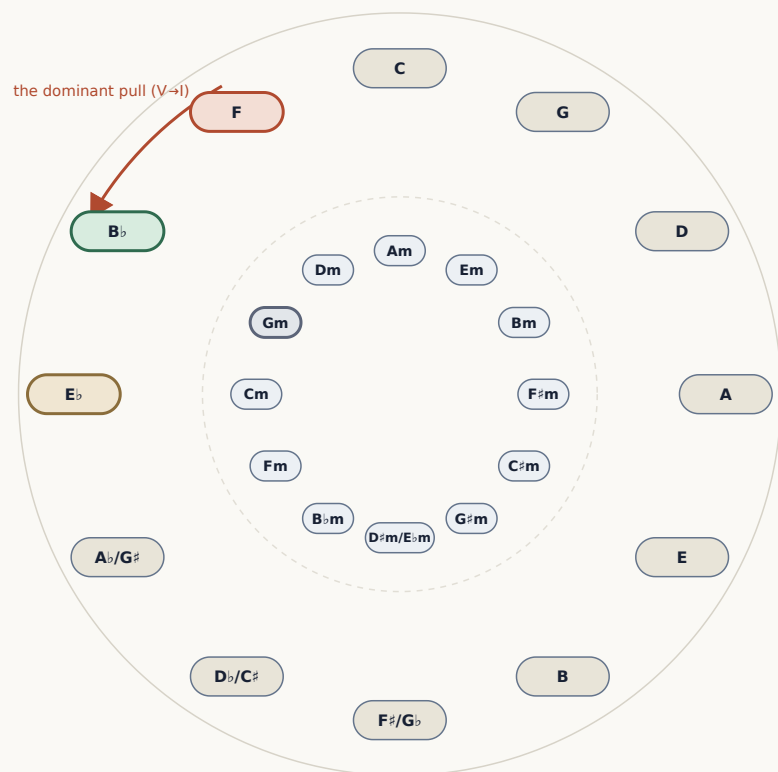
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in B $\flat$ major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in B $\flat$ major

I · B $\flat$ tonic	ii · Cm subdom.	iii · Dm linking	IV · E $\flat$ subdom.	V · F dominant	vi · Gm rel. minor	vii $^{\circ}$ · Adim side
x	x	x x ○	x		3	
B $\flat$ I · tonic	Cm ii · subdom.	Dm iii · linking	E $\flat$ IV · subdom.	F V · dominant	Gm vi · rel. minor	

Adim
vii $^{\circ}$ · skip it
pull substitute:
A7
x02020

Notation: ○ = open string, x = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in B $\flat$ major)

I - IV - V

B $\flat$ - E $\flat$ - F

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

B $\flat$ - F - Gm - E $\flat$

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Gm - E $\flat$ - B $\flat$ - F

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

B $\flat$ - Gm - E $\flat$ - F

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

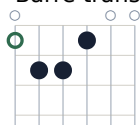
Cm - F - B $\flat$

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

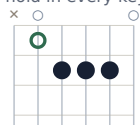
B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ 7	E $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	F7	E $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	F7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



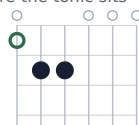
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



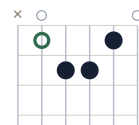
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of B $\flat$:

capo 1 + A major shapes

B $\flat$, Cm, Dm, E $\flat$, F, Gm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

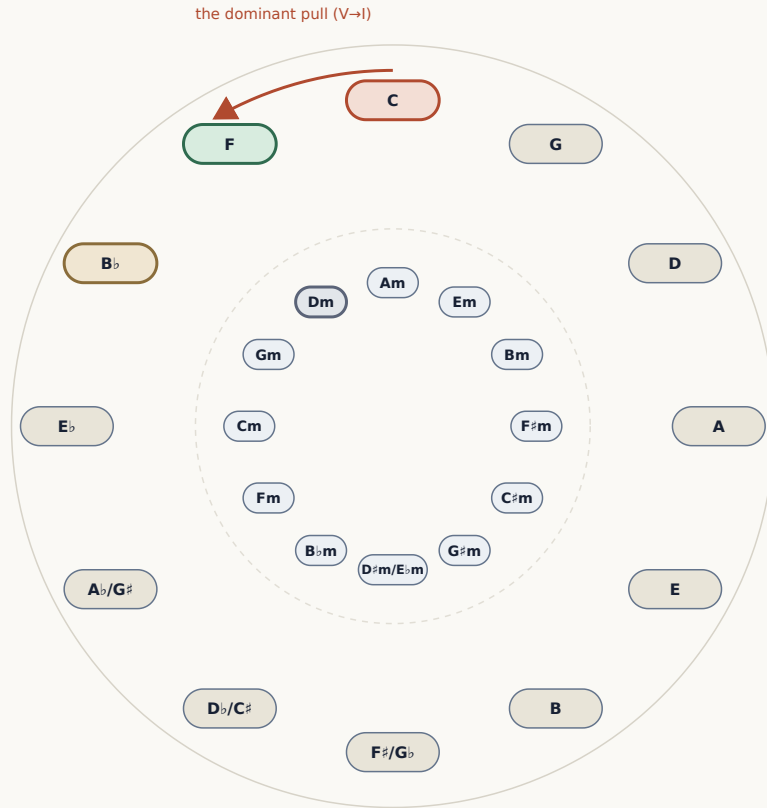
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in F major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

Diatonic chords in F major

I · F tonic	ii · Gm subdom.	iii · Am linking	IV · B $\flat$ subdom.	V · C dominant	vi · Dm rel. minor	vii $^\circ$ · Edim side
F I · tonic	Gm ii · subdom.	Am iii · linking	B $\flat$ IV · subdom.	C V · dominant	Dm vi · rel. minor	Edim vii $^\circ$ · skip it pull substitute: E7 020100

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in F major)

I - IV - V

F - B $\flat$ - C

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

F - C - Dm - B $\flat$

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Dm - B $\flat$ - F - C

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

F - Dm - B $\flat$ - C

do-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

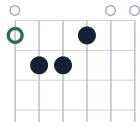
Gm - C - F

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

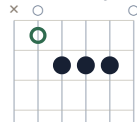
F7	F7	F7	F7	B $\flat$ 7	B $\flat$ 7	F7	F7	C7	B $\flat$ 7	F7	C7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



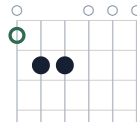
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



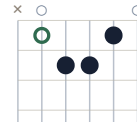
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of F:

F/Gm/B $\flat$ barre, Am/C/D open; otherwise capo 5 + shapes
C major → F, Gm, Am, B $\flat$, C, Dm.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

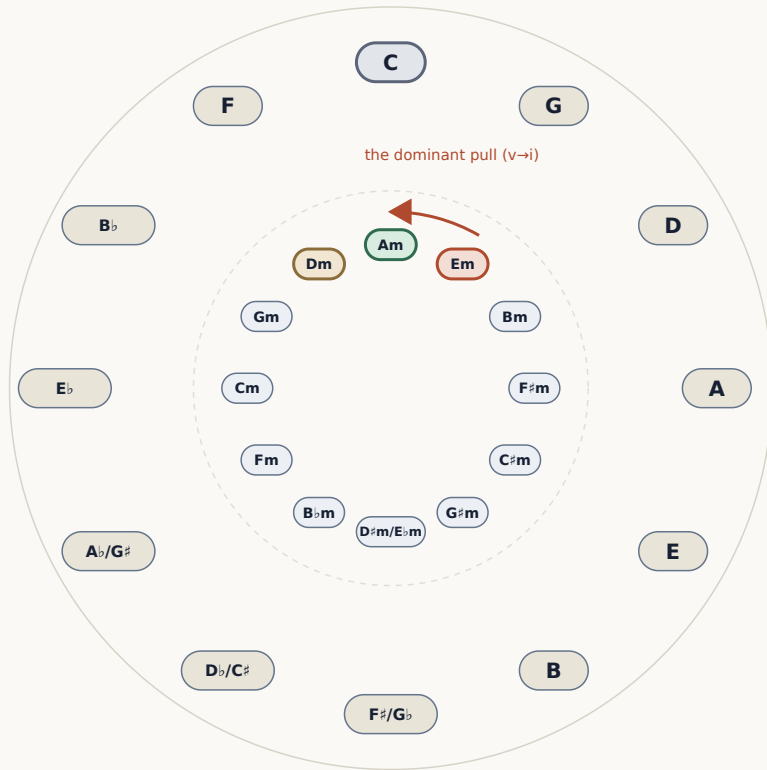
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: I tonic · IV subdominant · V dominant · vi rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in A minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of A minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in A minor

Functions: **i** · **iv**/VI · **v** · III

i · Am tonic	ii° · Bdim side	III · C rel. major	iv · Dm subdom.	v · Em minor dom.	VI · F subdom.	VII · G side
Am i · tonic	Bdim ii° · skip it take iv instead: Dm	C III · rel. major	Dm iv · subdom.	Em v · minor dom.	F VI · subdom.	G VII · side

E7
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 020100

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in A minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Am - F - C - G

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Am - Dm - E7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Am - G - F - E

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Am - G - F - Em

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

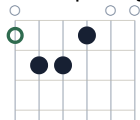
Am - C - G - F

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

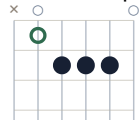
Am7	Am7	Am7	Am7	Am7	Am7	Am7	Am7	E7	Am7	Am7	E7
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Transposing on the guitar: one barre shape, any key



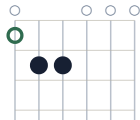
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



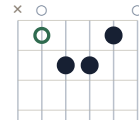
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

How to read it: a barre = one finger across all strings,
at the chosen fret — the shape stays, only the position changes.

The green ring marks where the tonic sits (the chord's name).

Progressions work in EVERY minor key — you shift them along the circle:

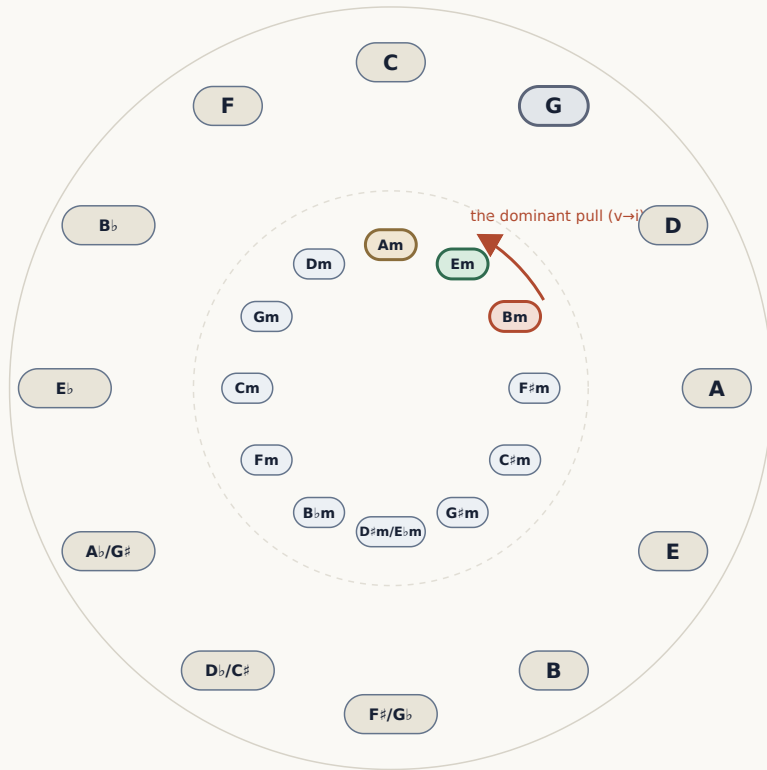
e.g. a-F-C-G (Am-F-C-G) → E minor: Em-C-G-D.

Functions: **i** tonic · **iv**/VI subdominant · **v** dominant

III the major sibling — the notes change, not the roles.

Chord progressions in E minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of E minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in E minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · Em tonic	ii° · F#dim side	III · G rel. major	iv · A subdom.	v · Bm minor dom.	VI · C subdom.	VII · D side
Em i · tonic	F#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: A	G III · rel. major	A iv · subdom.	Bm v · minor dom.	C VI · subdom.	D VII · side

the v7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x21202

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in E minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Em - C - G - D

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Em - A - B7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Em - D - C - B

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Em - D - C - Bm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

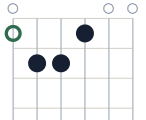
Em - G - D - C

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

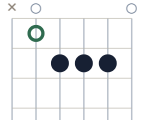
Em7	Em7	Em7	Em7	Em7	Em7	Em7	Em7	B7	Em7	Em7	B7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



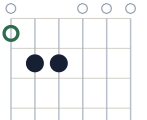
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



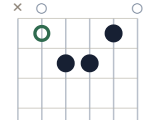
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of E minor:

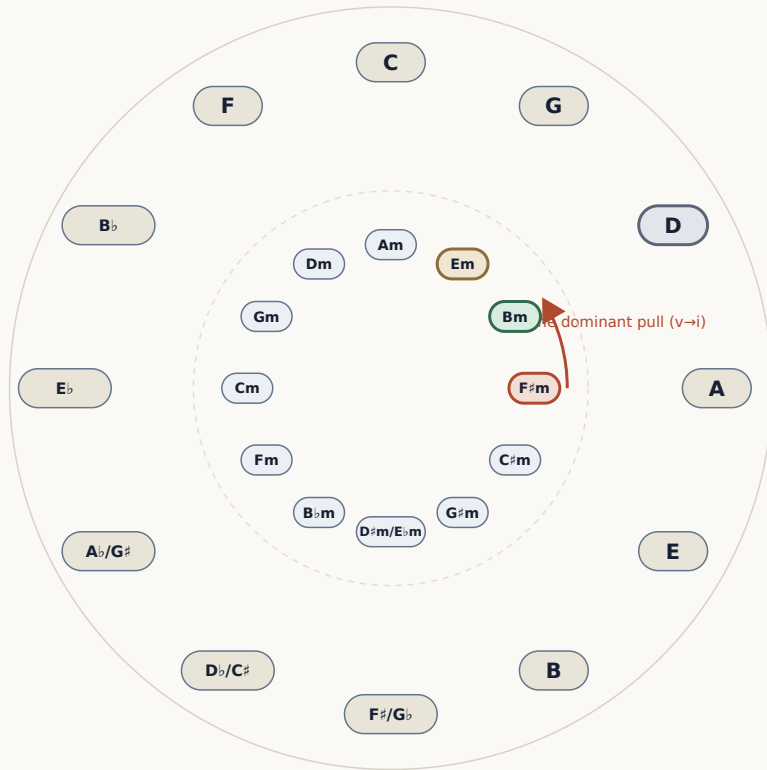
All open shapes except Bm

(barre at fret 2) — otherwise capo 2 + A-minor shapes (Am→Bm, Dm→Em, C→D, G→A, Em→F#m)

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in B minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of B minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in B minor

Functions: i · iv/VI · v · III

i · Bm tonic	ii° · C#dim side	III · D rel. major	iv · Em subdom.	v · F#m minor dom.	VI · G subdom.	VII · A side
Bm i · tonic	C#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: Em	D III · rel. major	Em iv · subdom.	F#m v · minor dom.	G VI · subdom.	A VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 242322

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in B minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Bm - G - D - A

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Bm - Em - F#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Bm - A - G - F#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Bm - A - G - F#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

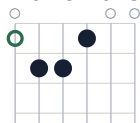
Bm - D - A - G

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

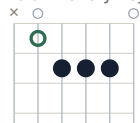
Bm7	Bm7	Bm7	Bm7	Bm7	Bm7	Bm7	Bm7	F#7	Bm7	Bm7	F#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



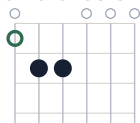
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



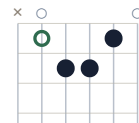
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of B minor:

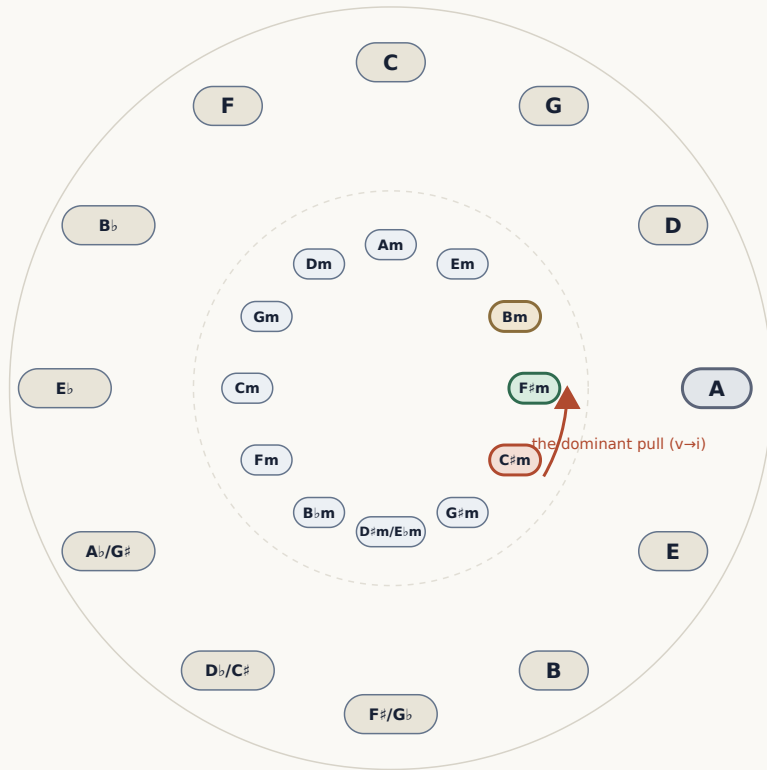
capo 2 + A minor shapes

(Am→Bm, Dm→Em, Em→F#m, F→G, C→D, G→A).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in F# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of F# minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in F# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · F#m tonic	ii° · G#dim side	III · A rel. major	iv · B subdom.	v · C#m minor dom.	VI · D subdom.	VII · E side
F#m i · tonic	G#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: B	A III · rel. major	B iv · subdom.	C#m v · minor dom.	D VI · subdom.	E VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x46464

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in F# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

F#m - D - A - E

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

F#m - B - C#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

F#m - E - D - C#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

F#m - E - D - C#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

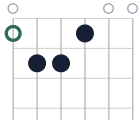
F#m - A - E - D

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

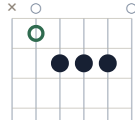
F#m7	F#m7	F#m7	F#m7	F#m7	F#m7	F#m7	F#m7	C#7	F#m7	F#m7	C#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



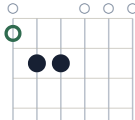
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



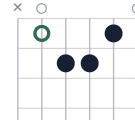
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of F# minor:

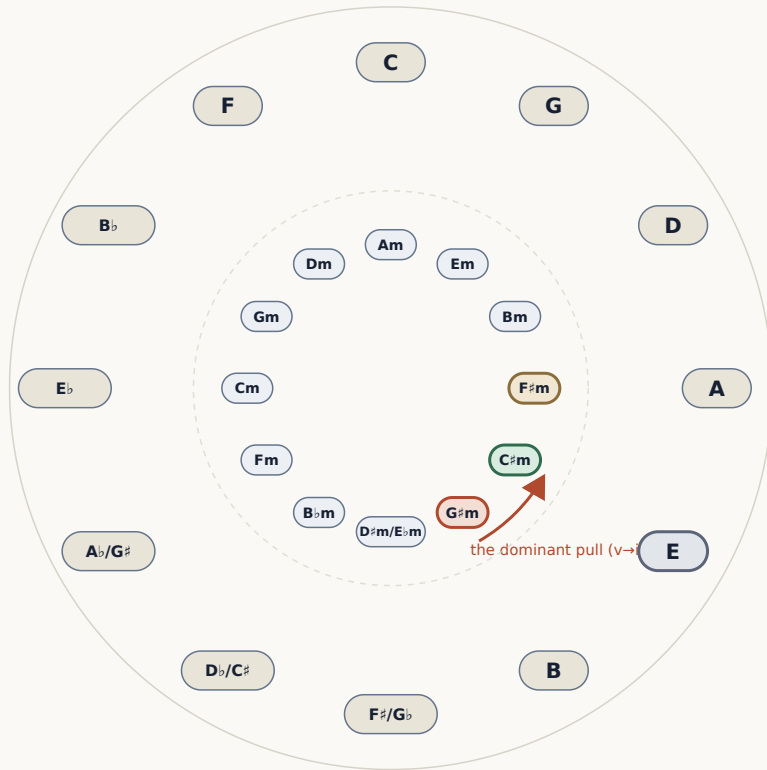
capo 2 + E minor shapes

(Em→F#m, G→A, A→B, Bm→C#m, C→D, D→E).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in C# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of C# minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in C# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · C#m tonic	ii° · D#dim side	III · E rel. major	iv · F#m subdom.	v · G#m minor dom.	VI · A subdom.	VII · B side
	 D#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: F#m					
C#m i · tonic		E III · rel. major	F#m iv · subdom.	G#m v · minor dom.	A VI · subdom.	B VII · side

G#7
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 464544

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in C# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

C#m - A - E - B

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

C#m - F#m - G#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

C#m - B - A - G#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

C#m - B - A - G#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

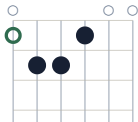
C#m - E - B - A

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

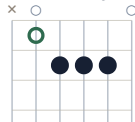
C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	C#m7	G#7	C#m7	C#m7	G#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



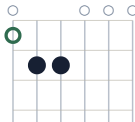
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



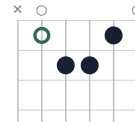
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of C# minor:

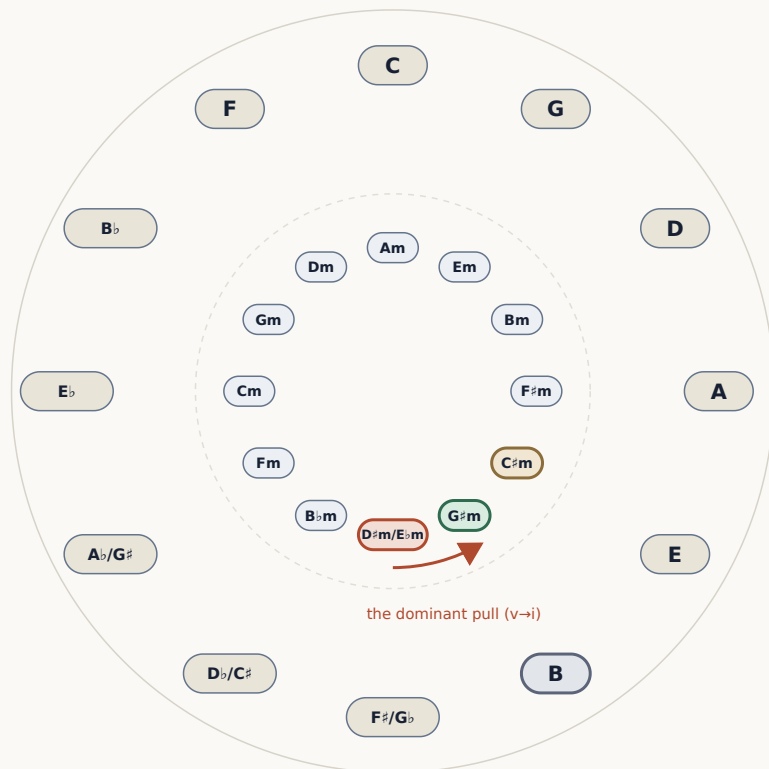
capo 4 + A minor shapes

(Am→C#m, Dm→F#m, Em→G#m, F→A, G→B, C→E).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in G# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of G# minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in G# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · G#m tonic	ii° · A#dim side	III · B rel. major	iv · C#m subdom.	v · D#m minor dom.	VI · E subdom.	VII · F# side
G#m i · tonic	A#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: C#m	B III · rel. major	C#m iv · subdom.	D#m v · minor dom.	E VI · subdom.	F# VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x6866

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in G# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

G#m - E - B - F#

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

G#m - C#m - D#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

G#m - F# - E - D#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

G#m - F# - E - D#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

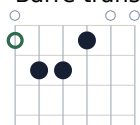
G#m - B - F# - E

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

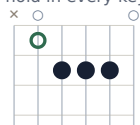
G#m7	G#m7	G#m7	G#m7	G#m7	G#m7	G#m7	G#m7	D#7	G#m7	G#m7	D#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



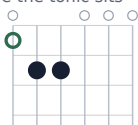
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



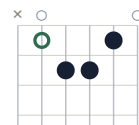
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

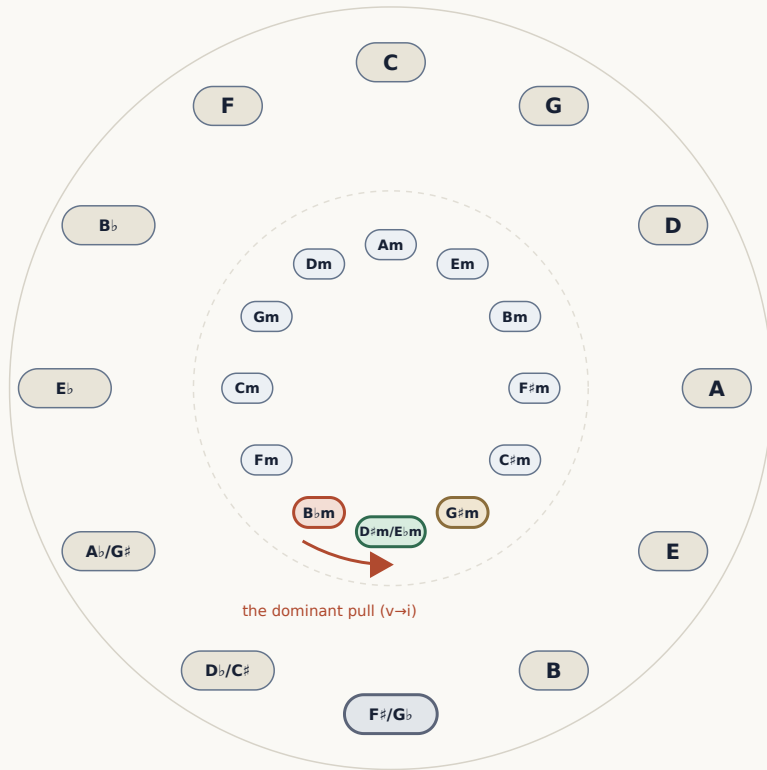
The easiest way — the key of G# minor:

capo 4 + E minor shapes
(Em→G#m, G→B, A→C#, Bm→D#m, C→E, D→F#).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in D# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of D# minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in D# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · D#m tonic	ii° · E#dim side	III · F# rel. major	iv · G#m subdom.	v · A#m minor dom.	VI · B subdom.	VII · C# side
D#m i · tonic	E#dim ii° · skip it take iv instead: G#m	F# III · rel. major	G#m iv · subdom.	A#m v · minor dom.	B VI · subdom.	C# VII · side

A#7
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x13131

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in D# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

D#m - B - F# - C#

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

D#m - G#m - A#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

D#m - C# - B - A#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

D#m - C# - B - A#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

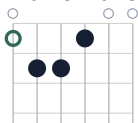
D#m - F# - C# - B

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

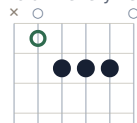
D#m7	D#m7	D#m7	D#m7	D#m7	D#m7	D#m7	D#m7	A#7	D#m7	D#m7	A#7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



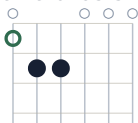
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



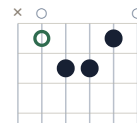
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of D# minor:

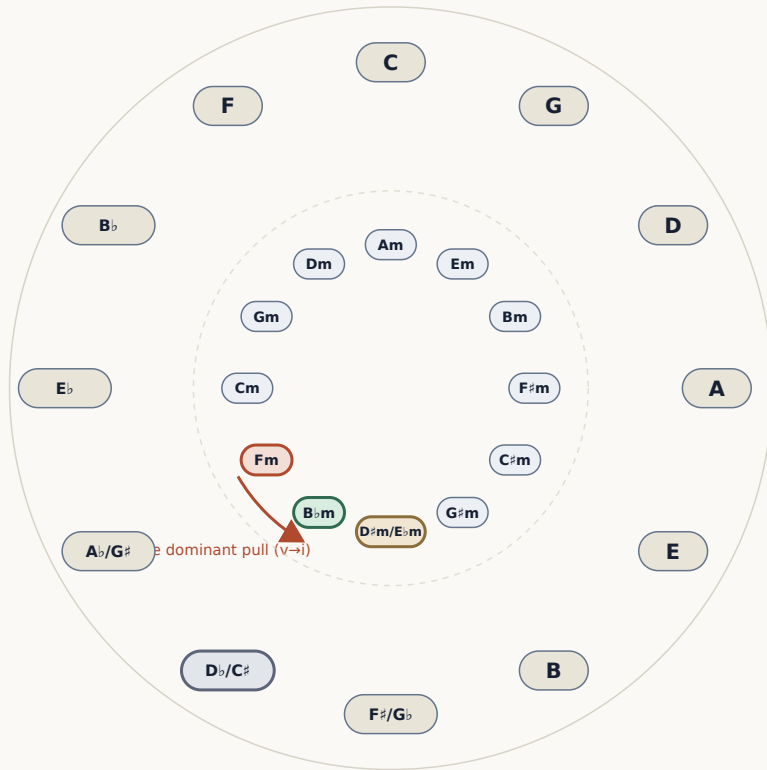
capo 6 + A minor shapes

(Am→D#m, Dm→G#m, Em→A#m, F→B, G→C#, C→F#).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in B $\flat$ minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of B $\flat$ minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in B $\flat$ minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · B $\flat$ m tonic	ii $^\circ$ · Cdim side	III · D $\flat$ rel. major	iv · E $\flat$ m subdom.	v · Fm minor dom.	VI · G $\flat$ subdom.	VII · A $\flat$ side
B $\flat$ m i · tonic	Cdim ii $^\circ$ · skip it take iv instead: E $\flat$ m	D $\flat$ III · rel. major	E $\flat$ m iv · subdom.	Fm v · minor dom.	G $\flat$ VI · subdom.	A $\flat$ VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 131211

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in B $\flat$ minor)

i - VI - III - VII

B $\flat$ m - G $\flat$ - D $\flat$ - A $\flat$

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

B $\flat$ m - E $\flat$ m - F7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

B $\flat$ m - A $\flat$ - G $\flat$ - F

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

B $\flat$ m - A $\flat$ - G $\flat$ - Fm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

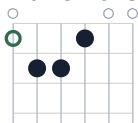
B $\flat$ m - D $\flat$ - A $\flat$ - G $\flat$

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

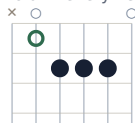
B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	F7	B $\flat$ m7	B $\flat$ m7	F7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



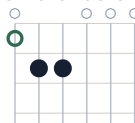
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



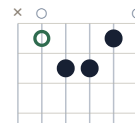
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of B $\flat$ minor:

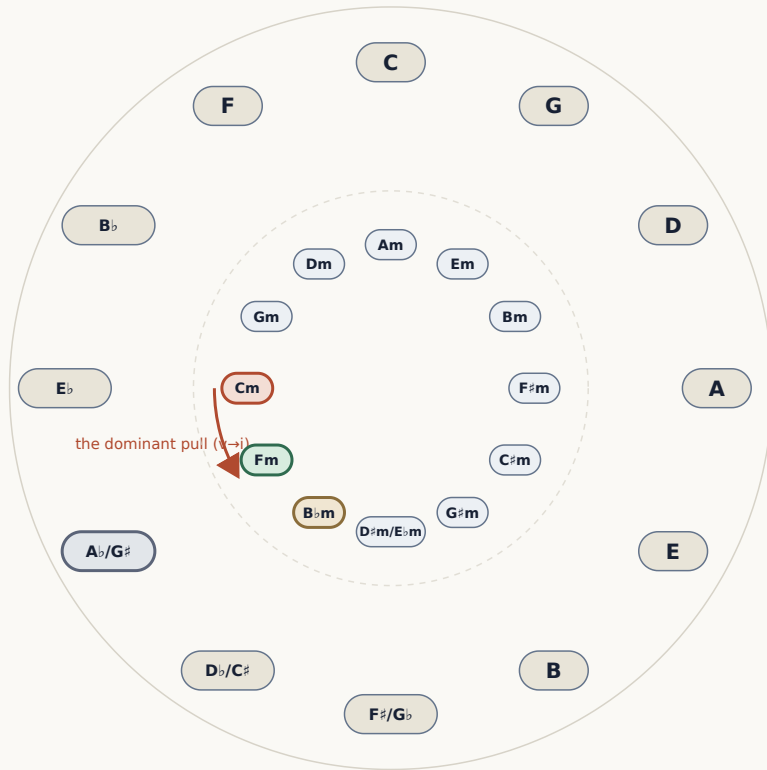
capo 1 + A minor shapes

(Am→B $\flat$ m, Dm→E $\flat$ m, Em→Fm, F→G $\flat$, G→A $\flat$, C→D $\flat$).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in F minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of F minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in F minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · Fm tonic	ii° · Gdim side	III · Ab rel. major	iv · Bbm subdom.	v · Cm minor dom.	VI · Db subdom.	VII · Eb side
Fm i · tonic	Gdim ii° · skip it take iv instead: Bbm	Ab III · rel. major	Bbm iv · subdom.	Cm v · minor dom.	Db VI · subdom.	Eb VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x32310

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in F minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Fm - Db - Ab - Eb

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Fm - Bbm - Cm

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Fm - Eb - Db - C

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Fm - Eb - Db - Cm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

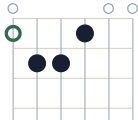
Fm - Ab - Eb - Db

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

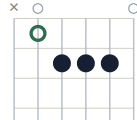
Fm7	Fm7	Fm7	Fm7	Fm7	Fm7	Fm7	Fm7	C7	Fm7	Fm7	C7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



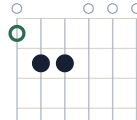
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



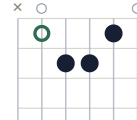
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of F minor:

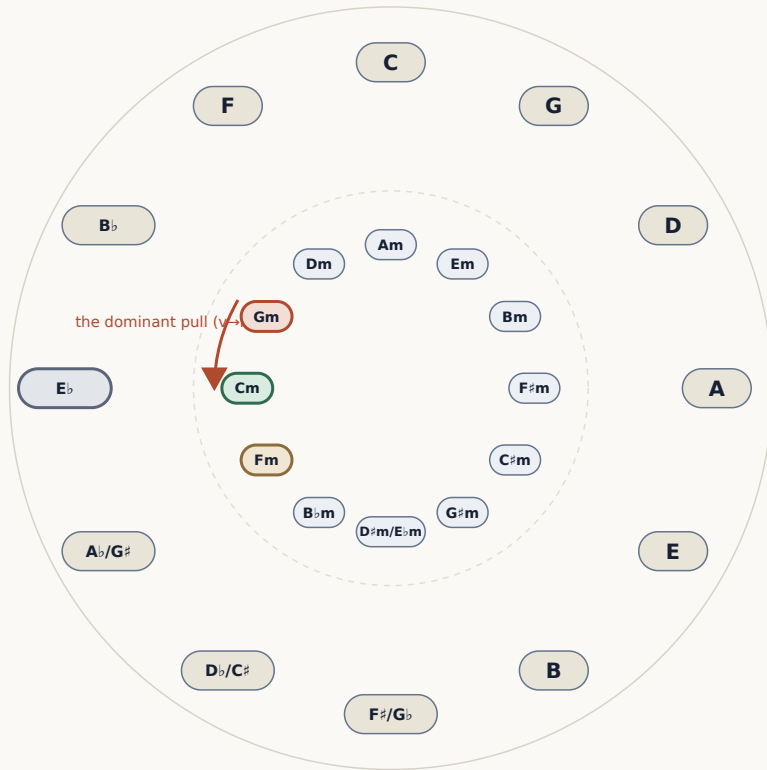
capo 1 + E minor shapes

(Em→Fm, G→Ab, A→Bb, Bm→Cm, C→Db, D→Eb).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in C minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of C minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in C minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · Cm tonic	ii° · Ddim side	III · Eb rel. major	iv · Fm subdom.	v · Gm minor dom.	VI · Ab subdom.	VII · Bb side
i · tonic	ii° · skip it take iv instead: Fm	III · rel. major	iv · subdom.	v · minor dom.	VI · subdom.	VII · side

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: 320001

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in C minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Cm - Ab - Eb - Bb

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Cm - Fm - G7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Cm - Bb - Ab - G

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Cm - Bb - Ab - Gm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

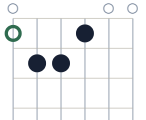
Cm - Eb - Bb - Ab

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

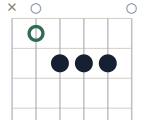
Cm7	Cm7	Cm7	Cm7	Cm7	Cm7	Cm7	Cm7	G7	Cm7	Cm7	G7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



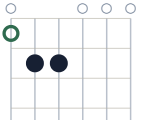
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



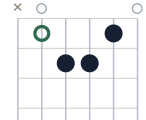
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of C minor:

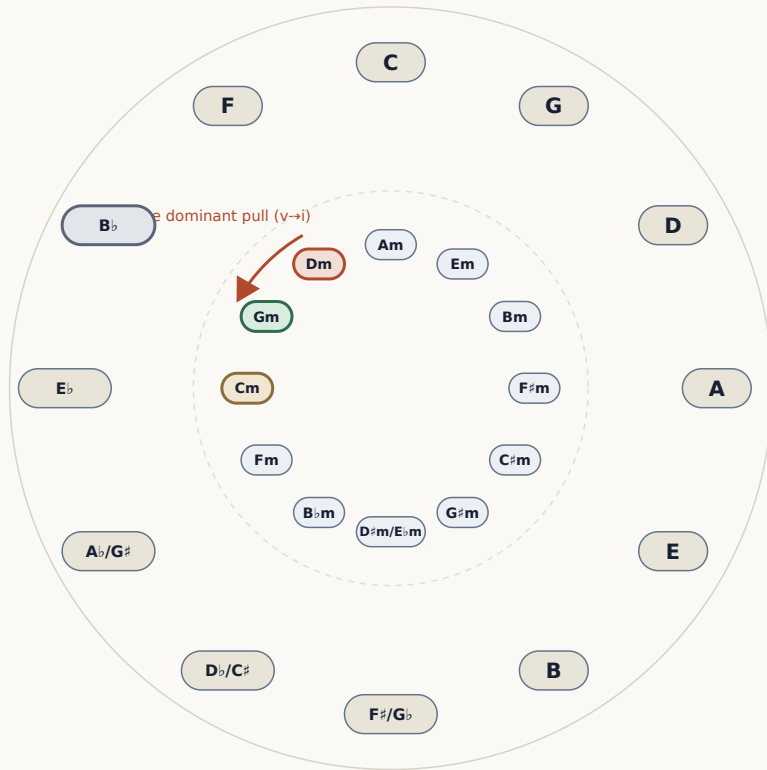
capo 3 + A minor shapes

(Am→Cm, Dm→Fm, Em→Gm, F→Ab, G→Bb, C→Eb).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in G minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of G minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in G minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · Gm tonic	ii° · Adim side	III · B♭ rel. major	iv · C subdom.	v · Dm minor dom.	VI · E♭ subdom.	VII · F side
i · tonic	ii° · skip it take iv instead: C	III · rel. major	iv · subdom.	v · minor dom.	VI · subdom.	VII · side

D7
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: xx0212

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in G minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Gm - E♭ - B♭ - F

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Gm - C - D7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Gm - F - E♭ - D

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Gm - F - E♭ - Dm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

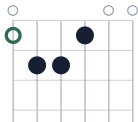
Gm - B♭ - F - E♭

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

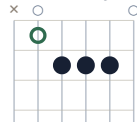
Gm7	Gm7	Gm7	Gm7	Gm7	Gm7	Gm7	Gm7	D7	Gm7	Gm7	D7
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Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



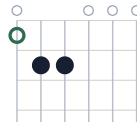
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



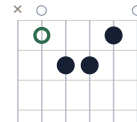
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of G minor:

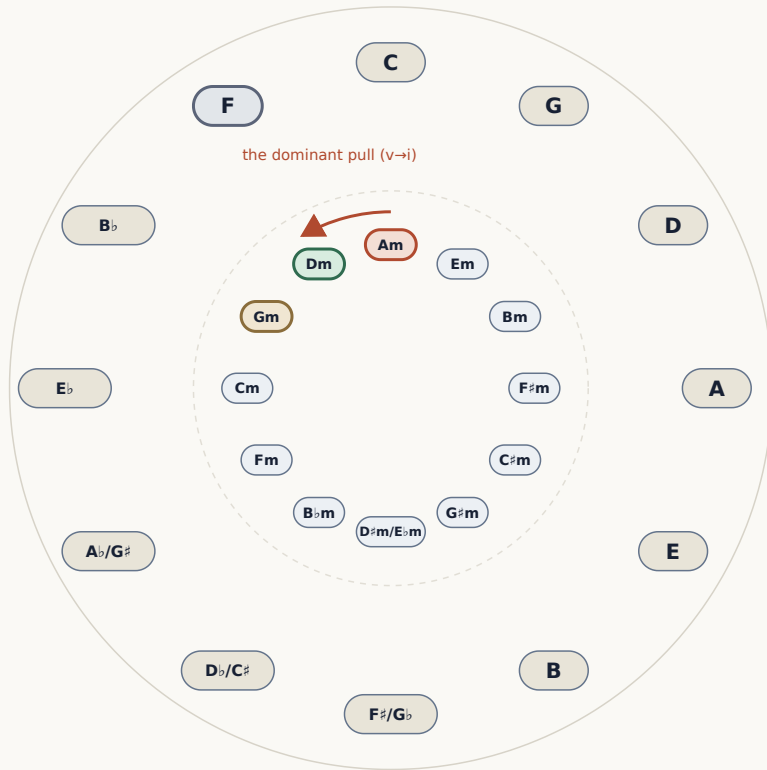
capo 3 + E minor shapes

(Em→Gm, G→B♭, A→C, Bm→Dm, C→E♭, D→F).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

Chord progressions in D minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of D minor is highlighted.

Diatonic chords in D minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

i · Dm tonic	ii° · Edim side	III · F rel. major	iv · G subdom.	v · Am minor dom.	VI · Bb subdom.	VII · C side
Dm i · tonic	Edim ii° · skip it take iv instead: G	F III · rel. major	G iv · subdom.	Am v · minor dom.	Bb VI · subdom.	C VII · side

A7
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)
shape: x02020

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

Proven progressions (in D minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Dm - Bb - F - C

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Dm - G - A7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - v

Dm - C - Bb - A

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Dm - C - Bb - Am

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

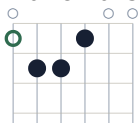
Dm - F - C - Bb

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

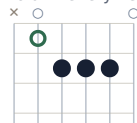
Dm7 Dm7 Dm7 Dm7 Dm7 Dm7 Dm7 Dm7 A7 Dm7 Dm7 A7

Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



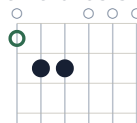
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10
tonic on string 6



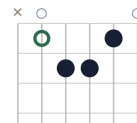
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8
tonic on string 5

The easiest way — the key of D minor:

No capo — Dm/F/G/Am/Bb/C mostly open shapes; otherwise capo 5 + A-minor shapes (Am→Dm)

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes